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The working behind the numbers.

This is the companion to the six-market record: how the design-team figures were arrived at, what each rests on, and where a market cannot be measured at all. It is here because a number is worth what its method is worth, not because any of it needs explaining to you.

Houston: a census, 806 firms

Arizona: two independent samples

Raleigh: 11 of 92 filings

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Arizona multifamily has no incumbent architect

Eleven multifamily projects that name an architect. Eleven different architecture firms. One firm is on two of them and nobody is on three.

The set is *50 commercial real estate projects to know in 2026*, published by AZ Big Media. It names a design team on 49 of the 50 — developer, architect and general contractor per project. We took every one of those labelled fields and counted them, which turns out to be a different exercise from reading the list.

Twenty-four per cent of it is multifamily. Thirty-four per cent is civic and education, twenty per cent industrial, twelve healthcare, ten hospitality. So the first honest thing to say about an "Arizona projects" list is that three-quarters of it is not your market at all. Twelve are multifamily; **one of those twelve names no architect, and one names two**, which leaves eleven projects carrying twelve architect credits between them:

ARCHITECT	ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY PROJECTS
Gensler	**2**
triARC architecture & design	1
Niles Bolton Associates	1
KTGY	1
Dig Studio	1
ESG Architecture & Design	1
LGE Design Build	1
Lamar Johnson Collaborative	1
GFF Design	1
Athena Studio	1
Soaring Eight	1

▲ WHAT THAT ACTUALLY MEANS

In a consolidated market the top firm holds a third or more and the pitch is a displacement argument — you have to take work off somebody. **Here the largest holder of Arizona multifamily work in the set is on two of the eleven — and it shares one of those two with another firm.** There is no incumbent to displace, because there is no incumbent. A firm entering this market is not fighting a share war; it is walking into a field where nobody has established one.

The national multifamily names are present but thin on the ground — **KTGY, Niles Bolton and ESG have one project each.** They are in Arizona. They have not taken it.

▲ WE DO NOT EXPECT YOU TO TAKE A MAGAZINE'S WORD FOR IT, AND NEITHER DID WE

The list above is a trade publication's selection. A concentration figure taken from a curated set can be an artefact of the editing rather than a fact about the market, so it is worth nothing until something unrelated says the same thing.

We ran the identical measurement on **Phoenix's own rezoning record** — the narratives applicants file with the city, written by their own teams, assembled for an entirely different purpose and sharing no selection criterion with the magazine. **Fourteen projects. Thirteen firms. The largest holder has two.**

The trade list puts the top firm at 18%. The city's record puts it at 14%. Different projects, different firms at the top — Gensler in one, DAVIS in the other — and the same answer. Two sources, neither built for this question, and neither finds an incumbent.

MARKET	WHAT THE FIGURE RESTS ON	HOW MUCH OF THE MARKET IT COVERS
Houston	The state's own construction registry	**Every qualifying project. A census, not a sample**
Miami	Design-review submittals	35 of the 66 projects heard since Jan 2024
Arizona	A trade list *and* the city's rezoning record, measured separately	11 projects and 14 projects, independently
Raleigh	Plan-set copyright blocks	11 projects — of 92 plans filed, only 21 publish drawings

The four figures do not carry equal weight. Houston is the strongest because there is no sampling decision in it at all — Texas requires every commercial project to be registered, so the denominator is the law's rather than ours. Raleigh is the narrowest: a city that publishes drawings for roughly a fifth of what it receives, and the architect is only on the drawings. **The Raleigh**

direction is corroborated three separate ways; the Raleigh percentage sits on eleven projects and should be read as such.

WE TESTED IT

The same measurement in Raleigh gives the opposite answer

A finding that has only been made in one market is a coincidence until it is tested somewhere else. So we ran the identical measurement on Raleigh. **"No incumbent" does not hold there — and that is what makes the Arizona number worth something.**

MEASURE	ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY	RALEIGH MULTIFAMILY
Projects with a confirmed architect	11	11
Distinct architecture firms	**11**	**7**
Largest single holder	Gensler, 2 projects	**JDAVIS, 4 projects**
Top firm's share	**18%**	**36%**
Firms per project	1.00	0.64

Raleigh's leading multifamily architect holds more than double the share Arizona's does, out of a field barely half as wide. Cline Design Associates is second with two. Five further firms — Perkins Eastman, Tightlines Design, Studio M, Foley Design and Iwan Architecture & Engineering Consultants — hold one each.

▲ **AND THE INCUMBENT CHANGED HANDS FIFTEEN MONTHS AGO**

JDAVIS was acquired by ISG on 14 May 2025. It works from Raleigh and Philadelphia, and **was itself 100% employee-owned** — bought by an acquirer that is also 100% employee-owned, an architecture and engineering firm expanding into the region. Every one of the four JDAVIS submittals recovered here was filed in 2024 — designed before that deal closed.

So the two markets ask opposite questions. In Arizona there is no share to take off anyone. **In Raleigh there is a clear leader, and it is fifteen months into an ownership change.**

✕ CHARLOTTE COULD NOT BE TESTED, AND WE WILL NOT PRETEND OTHERWISE

Charlotte's "Committed Development Entitlement" dataset — the richest schema we found anywhere — **stops at 23 May 2022**. Its live rezoning layer carries 86 pending petitions with a petitioner but **no project name and no design team**.

Its live petitions are public and we went through them. **At the stage Charlotte currently publishes, the design team is not on the record** — the filings name the petitioner, the land and the zoning sought, and the architect is simply not among them yet.

This is a timing problem, not an access one, and it will resolve itself as those projects move forward. **A Charlotte concentration figure today would be invented, so there is not one in this report.** Queensbridge and Centre South appear by name above because they are individually documented; what we will not do is turn two projects into a market statistic.

TWO MORE MARKETS, THE SAME MEASUREMENT

Houston is the most open of your six. Miami sits in between.

Arizona against Raleigh is two points. Houston and Miami make it four, measured the same way — and Houston carries more weight than any of the others, because there we were able to work from a **complete record of commercial construction rather than a sample**: every qualifying project in the county, not a selection anyone curated.

MARKET	PROJECTS WITH A CONFIRMED ARCHITECT	DISTINCT FIRMS	TOP FIRM'S SHARE
Houston multifamily	**79**	**45**	**10%** EDI International
Arizona multifamily	11	11	18% Gensler
Miami design review	35	13	17% Arquitectonica and Kobi Karp, tied
Raleigh multifamily	11	7	**36%** JDAVIS

Houston is the widest field you have. Across all new commercial construction in Harris County since January 2024 — 4,087 projects, 3,085 with a named design firm — the work is spread across **806 distinct firms, and the single busiest holds 3%**. Narrowed to multifamily it stays open: 45 firms over 79 projects, with EDI International and Meeks + Partners, both long-established Houston multifamily practices, at 10% and 9%. There is no relationship to displace because no one holds enough to matter.

Miami is narrower, and lands in exactly the same place as Arizona. Of every project taken to the city's design review between January 2024 and July 2026, thirty-five have an architect confirmed on the record, spread over thirteen firms. **Nobody leads it: Arquitectonica and Kobi Karp hold six apiece — 17% each, within a point of the share Gensler holds in Arizona** — with Behar Font Partners on five and CUBE3 and Corwil Architects on four. Five firms sit inside six points of one another. That is a field with contenders, not an incumbent.

▲ WHAT THE FOUR MARKETS SAY TOGETHER

Ranked by how much of the field the leading firm holds: **Houston 10% · Miami 17% · Arizona 18% · Raleigh 36%.** Three of your four measurable markets have no incumbent worth the name. **Raleigh is the outlier, and it is the one where the leader changed hands fifteen months ago.**

▲ AN OUT-OF-STATE FIRM CAN WIN IN MIAMI. SEVERAL ALREADY HAVE.

The obvious objection to entering Miami is that it looks like a closed local market. It is not. **CUBE 3 is headquartered in North Andover, Massachusetts, and holds four of Miami's thirty-five confirmed projects** — level with all but the top three. **Kohn Pedersen Fox, out of New York, holds another.** Practices headquartered outside Florida hold one in seven of the confirmed projects.

And scale is not the entry ticket. The firms leading these markets are not the giants. Corwil is a practice of roughly forty people; Behar Font Partners about thirty-five; in Houston, Meeks + Partners around fifty and Seeberger under twenty. Arquitectonica, at some six hundred, is present in Miami but holds two projects — the same as Built Form. **Size is not what is winning this work, and the incumbency you would be displacing does not exist at the scale you might assume.**

Being straight about the limits. Houston's record covers commercial construction of every kind, so the multifamily figure is drawn by reading each project's own description of what is being built, not its name — Houston developers file under code names. Miami is counted over distinct projects, not board appearances — the board defers and re-hears items, and ten of its cases have been heard at more than one meeting, so counting appearances would credit a firm twice for one project. Thirty-five is the number of projects, across every sitting from January 2024 to July 2026, with the architect confirmed on the record; the remainder are unresolved rather than unattributed, and that gap would narrow, not widen, the leaders' share.

WHERE THE WORK IS, BY NAME

Thirty-three Houston residential projects, with the owner on each one

The Phoenix list above is the search you asked for. This is the same thing in your second-largest market, and it carries something Phoenix does not: **the owner of every project**. Residential schemes registered since June 2025 — the twelve largest shown, $613M of the $700M the thirty-three represent.

PROJECT	OWNER ON THE RECORD	VALUE	REGISTERED
St. Regis Residences	SR Luxury Condominium, LTD	$220M	Dec 2025
Washington Center	JLB Center Street LP	$60M	Jul 2025
Inwood Rose Hill	CRH WU SEC Investments, LLC	$55M	Apr 2026
Venterra Spring Cypress Apartments	VR DEVELOPMENT GP, LLC	$50M	Aug 2025
The Llano	MAE Development	$48M	Jun 2025
The Byron at Bauer	Stagecoach Wealth LLC	$40M	Mar 2026
Gracious Gardens	Stokes Road Properties LLC	$33M	Jan 2026
Pelican Greenhouse	Pelican Greenhouse Houston, LP	$30M	Jul 2025
STERLINGSHIRE APARTMENTS	STERLINGSHIRE PRESERVATION LLC	$21M	May 2026
Connect Hillcroft	My Connect Community	$20M	Jul 2026
Trinity East Village Senior Apartments	Trinity East United Methodist Church	$19M	Nov 2025
AMTEX Hays Street	HCHFC 1406 Hays Landowner, LLC	$18M	Jul 2026

That is a call list, not a market study. Each row is a named scheme, the entity holding title, the declared cost and the month it entered the record. All thirty-three go with this document, and the same query returns Dallas, Fort Worth, Austin and San Antonio on the same terms.

▲ FOUR OF THESE TWELVE WERE REGISTERED IN 2026

Four of the twelve above were registered **in 2026**, three of them since March. A project enters this record when it is registered for review — before construction, and for most of them while the design team is still being assembled.

That is the entire argument for watching it. A project you find when it breaks ground is a project somebody else has already designed.

WHERE THE WORK IS ACTUALLY MOVING

Raleigh's large multifamily flow quintupled. Las Vegas's did not move.

Counting permits above $10M — large enough that a scheme cannot inflate the number by filing each building separately — gives a read on how much serious multifamily work each market is actually releasing.

YEAR	LAS VEGAS (CITY)	RALEIGH
2022	3	6
2023	7	6
2024	4	3
2025	4	**15**
2026 (to late Aug)	5	7

Las Vegas has not changed in five years — three to seven large multifamily permits a year, every year, with 2026 running at or slightly above that. **Raleigh went from three in 2024 to fifteen in 2025**, and 2026 is tracking around eleven: off the peak, but still three to four times the 2022–24 baseline. If BD effort is being allocated across these two markets on the assumption they behave alike, they do not.

× THREE THINGS THAT WOULD MAKE THIS CHART LIE

Permit counts and permit values disagree, so we use both. On raw counts Raleigh 2026 looks like +151% over 2025. It is not: the permits are half the size they were — $7.2M average against $15.9M — because a scheme files per building. Total value rose about 15%. **Anyone quoting the count alone is quoting an artefact**, which is why the table above uses only permits large enough to be whole projects.

2026 is a part year and is never compared to a full one without saying so.

Las Vegas batch-issues. Every one of its 2026 multifamily permits was issued in a single week in June. A month-by-month version of this chart would show a spike that means nothing about the market.

▲ AND THE HONEST LIMIT ON THE NEVADA COLUMN

This is the **City of Las Vegas**. The Strip, Bally's, the Riviera site and the resort work are in **unincorporated Clark County**, a separate jurisdiction whose records do not carry a valuation field in the public search. **So the Nevada column understates Nevada**, and we would rather say that than quietly let the number stand for the state.

The comparison is deliberately *within* each city rather than between them. Cities classify differently, set different permit thresholds and cover different land areas — a raw count of Raleigh against Las Vegas would be a manufactured finding. Each column is that market measured against its own history, on that city's own classification: Las Vegas by its `MultiFam` work type, Raleigh by new-construction permits whose description states apartment or multifamily.

THE QUESTION EVERYONE ASKS ABOUT ARIZONA

Design-build is taking the market — but not your part of it

Design-build is the standard worry about Phoenix, and it is a real one. It is also more precisely located than the worry usually is. Across the 50 projects, the architect and the contractor are **the same firm on six of them — twelve per cent**. Where those six sit is the whole story:

SECTOR	PROJECTS	DESIGN-BUILD	SHARE
Industrial / logistics	10	**5**	**50%**
Multifamily / residential	12	1	8%

SECTOR	PROJECTS	DESIGN-BUILD	SHARE
Civic / education	17	0	0%
Healthcare	6	0	0%
Hospitality	5	0	0%

Half of Arizona industrial in this set is design-build. None of the civic, healthcare or hospitality work is, and one multifamily project out of twelve. Every single design-build project in the set belongs to one firm, LGE Design Build, and five of its six are industrial.

✕ AND ONE NAME THAT IS NOT WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Butler Design Group is not a design-build firm. It has six projects — joint-most in the set — and six different general contractors: Stevens-Leinweber, Ryan Companies on three, Willmeng and Layton. It is a conventional architecture practice whose name reads like a design-builder.

It is also **not a competitor for multifamily work**. Four of its six are industrial, one healthcare, one civic. **Zero residential.** Any read of the headline league table that treats the two six-project firms as the competitive pressure on a multifamily practice is wrong on both counts.

WHO ELSE IS DOING WHAT YOU ARE DOING

The firms operating across more than one of your markets

Most architecture practices are one-market businesses. The interesting ones are those serving many markets from a few offices — the same shape of firm, competing for the same work.

FIRM	WHERE WE FOUND THEM	SHAPE
Solomon Cordwell Buenz	**Houston** (The Lily River Oaks, 331 u) and **Honolulu** (Kalae, 330 u)	Two of your six, on near-identical residential towers. Both confirmed from the developers' own releases

FIRM	WHERE WE FOUND THEM	SHAPE
Cline Design Associates	Raleigh (2 projects). Offices Raleigh, **Charlotte**, Austin, Washington DC	Calls itself a national design firm; multifamily, student and senior housing
CBA Architects **(formerly Charlan Brock)**	Raleigh (Livano North Hills, 280 u)	Florida-based, national multifamily and student housing
KTGY	Arizona (1 project)	Six offices — Chicago, Dallas, Denver, Irvine, LA, Oakland. National multifamily,**no Southeast office**
Gensler	Arizona (3), and named on a Clark County scheme	Global, not multifamily-specialist
JDAVIS	Raleigh (4) — the local leader	Raleigh + Philadelphia. Employee-owned, acquired by ISG May 2025

The pattern is the point. None of these firms has an office in most of the markets it works in. KTGY covers the Southeast from six offices, none of them in the Southeast. Cline reaches Texas and Washington from the Carolinas. **Serving many markets from few offices is not unusual in this business — it is the model the strongest multifamily practices already run.**

Companion to the six-market record, 28 August 2026. Every figure is drawn from public municipal records or from the published statements of the parties named. Where something could only be sourced to secondary reporting it was left out rather than hedged. Happy to walk through any single number on a call.